

CFO-ORC FILE # 2002-128

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

(A)

NEW STATE RECORD ☐ UNUSUAL RECORD ☒

red'd 1/26/03

Species: American Black Duck x Mallard hybrid (*Anas rubripes* x *A. platyrhynchos*)

Date: 30 November 2002

Number seen: one

Sex: male

Plumage: adult

Locality: ponds on east side of town

Elevation: about 4000 feet

Nearest town: Haxtun

County: Phillips

Time observed: about 15:00 - 15:30

Duration of observation: a total of about 30 minutes

Description:

Overall, a very dark dabbling duck associating with Mallards (*Anas platyrhynchos*). The body was a dark chocolate brown from the neckline to the end of the tail. The head and neck were a lighter brown, contrasting with the rest of the body. There was a thin, dark brown eye-line running through the eye. The crown was also a darker brown than the rest of the head. The bill appeared to be more dusky yellow than the photos show. While swimming in the pond, several male Mallards head-bobbed, which the duck in question also did. There appeared to be a very fine white edging to the tail feathers, and several of the tail feathers curved upwards as in male Mallards.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): I heard none.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly-appearing species? I have seen ABDU on the east coast in the hundreds, but not for many years.

Light conditions: overcast with the sun setting behind me, poor lighting overall

Optical equipment used: Kowa scope 20x60 zoom

Distance, and how estimated: estimated closest distance at 50 meters

Other observers who saw the bird with you: none

Other observers who saw the bird independently: none that I know of

If photographed, type of equipment and film: Nikon Coolpix 4500 digital through scope

List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: none

b) after observation: 3rd ed. National Geographic

Reporting observer: Doug Faulkner

Signature:

Doug Faulkner

Address: Rocky Mountain Bird Observatory, 14500 Lark Bunting Lane, Brighton, CO 80601

Date report was written: This report was written on 17 January, 2003 from memory.